

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 10 8 6 2
 ♥ Q 10 4
 ♦ J 8 4 3
 ♣ 6

♠ 7 4

♥ K 7 5 2

♦ 9 5

♣ A Q 8 4 3



♠ Q 9 3

♥ J 9 8

♦ Q 10 7 2

♣ K 7 5

♠ A J 5

♥ A 6 3

♦ A K 6

♣ J 10 9 2

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by South
 at trick one. Do you win or hold up?

You should assume that West holds the ♠K.

If you take the ♠A right now your ♠J 5 will provide a second stopper if it is West who gets the lead. However, if East gets the lead he will play through your holding and you may lose 4 ♠ tricks.

If you hold up you can expect East to play another ♠ through your ♠A J and West will then establish the suit. However, in doing so he will remove any ♠ held by East.

The answer key lies in the ♣ suit. You will be finessing through West, so East is the only defender who can get the lead in ♣s. Therefore you must hold up on ♠s until the third round.

If you win the first ♠ East will play a ♠ through your ♠J 5 when he wins the ♣K. West will then swamp you with ♠s.

But, if you hold up your ♠A until the third round, East will have no ♠ left when he wins the ♣K.

With no 4-card Major suit you respond 2♦ to partner's Stayman bid. Partner now bids 2NT.

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With a full 17 points you accept partner's game invitation and bid 3NT.

South plays 3NT. West leads the ♠6 on which East plays the ♠Q.

Winner List: ♠ = 1 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 6

You need 3 more tricks, obviously coming from the ♣ suit.

But the burning question right now is what do you do

Board 4

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 4

♥ 5

♦ Q 9 6 2

♣ A 10 9 7 2

♠ A Q 3

♥ K 7

♦ A J 10 4

♣ K 8 6 5



♠ 8 7

♥ A 9 8 6 2

♦ K 7 5

♣ Q J 3

♠ K J 6 5 2

♥ Q J 10 4 3

♦ 8 3

♣ 4

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

2♦

Pass

2♥

Pass

2♠

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by South

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 2 : ♦ = 1 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 4

When you are 5-5 in the Majors you can transfer to either suit. Most will say transfer first to ♥s when you have invitational strength. So you bid 2♦.

Partner says 2♥;

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Partner says 2♥;

Now you show your other 5-card Major by bidding 2♠. This one hits the spot and partner raises to 4♠.

South plays 4♠. West leads the ♥5. East takes the ♥A and returns the ♥6 which West ruffs. West then plays the ♦2.

That's an odd way to show the second ♥ loser but you get the idea. You've lost 2 tricks already and it doesn't look like you can dodge the ♣A. Soooooo, you cannot afford to lose a ♦ trick.

Take dummy's ♦A and then play ♠A, ♠K, relaxing a little when both defenders follow suit both times.

Play your three high ♥s, discarding all three ♦s from dummy. Play your ♣ toward the ♣K. West will no doubt grab his ♣A but the rest will be yours, since you can ruff your ♦ loser in dummy.

It was a little unlucky to suffer that early ♥ ruff.

But it was very very lucky that the ruffer happened to be the defender with three trumps!

That meant you could pull trumps with two pulls, leaving that one important one in dummy.